

1970 ▶ 1975



The first space station, Salyut 1, was launched in 1971. A crew of three cosmonauts (Soviet astronauts) spent 23 days on board.

1970

Earth Day

Communities across the US came together on April 22 to celebrate Earth Day for the first time. Around 20 million Americans gathered in rallies and events held in more than 12,000 schools and colleges to raise awareness of environmental issues.

1971

Orbiting Mars

NASA's Mariner 9 became the first spacecraft to orbit another planet when it reached Mars. The unmanned craft sent back 7,329 photos of approximately 85 percent of the Martian surface, and discovered the solar system's largest volcano, Olympus Mons.

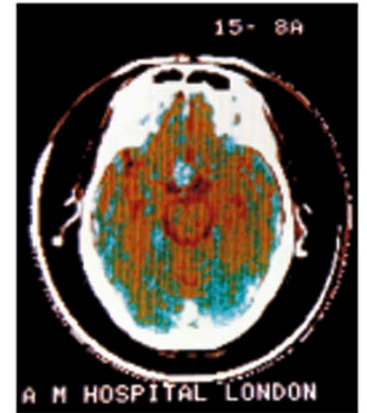


Olympus Mons (as seen by Mariner 9), which is 2.5 times the height of Mount Everest

1971

First CT Scan

A scanner developed by English engineer Godfrey Hounsfield took the first computerized tomography (CT) human brain scan, in London, UK. CT scanners take X-ray images of a part of the body. A computer assembles these to form a complete, sometimes three-dimensional, image.



CT scan from a hospital in Wimbledon, UK, 1972



1970

1970

Boeing 747 enters service

The Boeing 747 became the first wide-bodied jet airliner to start ferrying passengers. Its 231-ft- (70.6-m-) long fuselage could accommodate up to ten seats in a row plus two aisles (walkways), giving it a maximum capacity of 550 passengers. More than 1,500 Boeing 747 planes would be built.

The first Boeing 747 with its four large turbofan jet engines in Washington.



Taking to the skies
See pages 162–163

1971

Microprocessor

In 1971, a team at the technology company Intel developed the first commercial microprocessor, the Intel 4004. This small chip contained all the functions of a central processing unit of a computer. It went on sale on November 15, 1971.



Intel 4004